MY NAME IS IORI KITAHARA.

MOVING OUT OF MY PARENTS' HOUSE TO THIS SEASIDE TOWN,

I LOOKED FORWARD TO A NEW LIFE FULL OF HOPE AND FRESH EXPERIENCES.

AFTER GRADUATING FROM AN ALL-BOYS HIGH SCHOOL...

...I ENROLLED IN IZU UNIVERSITY THIS SPRING.

ON THE FIRST DAY OF SCHOOL? WHAT A MANIAC.

THAT'S THE GUY WHO WAS PASSED OUT DRUNK OUTSIDE THE LECTURE HALL ...

DUDE'S GOT GUTS, WALKING AROUND IN BOXERS...

WHISPER

CHATTER

...BUT IT ALL WENT UP IN SMOKE THE MOMENT SCHOOL STARTED.

Ch. 2 Welcoming Party

WH-WHAT SHOULD I DO?

AT THIS RATE, THE CAMPUS LIFE I DREAMED OF WILL...

WHISPER

HEY, CHECK OUT THAT GUY.

WHISPER

WHISPER

ISN'T HE KINDA HOT?

WHISPER

HUH? B-BUT ...

HM?

A-HA.

...

...

...

HE IS PRETTY HAND-SOME...

?!

ｲｯ
HEH

ﾊｯ
HEH

...

THERE'S ONE GUY I'LL STAY AWAY FROM.

GA HA HA HA HA HA HA

I'D LIKE TO CHECK THEM OUT MYSELF...

...BUT I'M AFRAID TO GO ALONE.

WHO KNOWS WHAT KIND OF CRAZIES MIGHT BE THERE.

TNK トゥトゥ TNK

THAT COVERS EVERY-THING.

PLEASE TURN IN YOUR RE-QUESTS FOR ELECTIVES BY THE SEVENTH.

CLUBS, HUH...

WHERE SHOULD WE START?

LET'S GO CHECK OUT THE CLUBS.

カバッ CLAT

HEY, CHISA. DO YOU WANT TO GO CHECK OUT THE CLUBS?

CHISA...

DON'T TALK TO ME DRESSED LIKE THAT.

H-HEY!

...

スタスタスタ TAP TAP TAP

I'D LIKE TO GO HOME AND GET CHANGED, BUT...

YEAH, THIS GETUP IS PRETTY BAD.

わ WOOOO っ

わ WOOOO っ

わ WOOOO っ

AH...

...I DON'T KNOW THE WAY BACK.

?

I'M GOING HOME.

ALL RIGHT. LET'S GO.

...

スチャッ WHISH

WHY ARE YOU FOL-LOWING ME?

I DON'T KNOW THE WAY, SO I THOUGHT YOU COULD SHOW ME.

,,,

NO WAY.

WHY NOT?!

DO I REALLY HAVE TO TELL YOU?

I MORE OR LESS UNDER-STAND.

I WISH THERE WAS NO ROOM FOR DOUBT, BUT WHAT-EVER.

ARE WE CLEAR, THEN? I'M LEAVING.

HOOOLD UP!

EXCUSE ME. A HALF-NAKED PERVERT IS ASKING ME TO HAND OVER MY CLOTHES.

SO, COULD YOU GIVE ME SOME OF YOUR CLOTHES? THAT WAY WE'LL BOTH BE HAPPY...

BUT I'M IN KIND OF A PINCH HERE.

YEAH. IT'S VERY CLEAR THAT YOU DON'T WANT TO WALK HOME WITH ME,

FAMILY HAS TO LOOK OUT FOR EACH OTHER, RIGHT ?!

MY PROB-LEMS ARE YOUR PROB-LEMS! YOUR CLOTHES ARE MY CLOTHES!

WE'RE COUS-INS, AREN'T WE?!

WHA–

GRAAAAAAAH

LIKE WHAT?

DON'T SAY THINGS LIKE THAT SO LOUDLY.

KNOCK IT OFF!

WAIT!

HMM. I SEE. IN THAT CASE...

DING ピーン

YOU KNOW ... ABOUT BEING COUS-INS AND STUFF.

...

...

...IF YOU DON'T GIVE ME YOUR SHIRT, THEN I'LL TELL EVERYONE WE'RE LIVING TOGETHER.

GRIT

GRIP

FINE ...

I'LL DO IT...

I'LL TAKE IT OFF ...

JUST PLEASE DON'T TELL EVERYONE ABOUT MY FAMILY'S CIRCUM-STANCES...

...

HANG ON. TAKEN OUT OF CONTEXT, THAT MAKES ME SOUND LIKE SOME KIND OF CRIM-

ポーンッ PAT

HUFF
HUFF
HUFF
HUFF

HUFF
HUFF

WHAT DID I DO TO DESERVE THIS?

What? Not us...

EXCUSE ME. DID YOU SEE A SUSPICIOUS HALF-NAKED MAN PASS BY HERE?

IT'S JUST YOU.

...OH.

WHOA!

WHAT ARE YOU DOING?

ぬっ CREEP

WHAT? SERIOUSLY?!

DEPENDING ON THE CIRCUMSTANCES, I DON'T MIND GIVING YOU A HAND.

HMM.

Pardon me.

IT'S...A LONG STORY.

THE NAME'S KOHEI IMAMURA.

SO, WHAT HAPPENED?

YOU'RE ACTUALLY A PRETTY GOOD GUY, HUH?!

GIMME ANOTHER CHANCE! PLEASE!

GRAB ガシッ

SECURITY!

NOT ONLY WOULD CHISA NOT BRING ME HOME WITH HER, BUT SHE WOULDN'T EVEN TAKE OFF HER CLOTHES FOR ME!

LISTEN TO THIS, KOHEI.

WH-WHAT?

FINE, SKIP THE EX-PLANATION. INSTEAD...

THERE'S AN EXPLA-NATION FOR ALL OF THAT!

WHY SHOULD I LISTEN TO ANYTHING YOU SAY?

ARE YOU KIDDING? SEXUAL ASSAULT AND STALKING?

WAIT!

ガシッ GRAB

THEN YOU CAN EX-PLAIN IT IN JAIL.

SEE YA.

TAKE OFF YOUR CLOTHES.

DAMN IT...

WHERE'D HE GO?

OH, SHIT. THERE'S MORE OF THEM...

ハァ ハァ WHEEZE ハァ ハァ WHEEZE

BUT THE ONLY OTHER PEOPLE I KNOW HERE ARE...

コソ TAP コソ TAP

THAT SAID, I NEED TO FIND SOME CLOTHES.

DRINK!! あぁ

...

DRINK!! あぁ

THAT ASS-HOLE. FIRST, HE KNOCKS ME ON MY ASS,

THEN HE CALLS SECURI-TY.

おるあ RAAA あAAAあ あAあ Hあ

I'D RATHER NOT DEAL WITH THEM ANYMORE, BUT SACRIFICES MUST BE MADE.

SKATE

GUI

WELCOME!

THEATE

PHOTO-GRAPHY CLUB

I ♡ MUSIC

CHOR

TEN

TEA CEREMON

KARATE

YO, CHECK OUT THAT HOTTIE.

SCUBA DIV-ING SOUNDS PRETTY COOL. I BET YOU'D MEET SOME CUTE GIRLS.

Thank you!

IS ANYONE INTER-ESTED IN DIVING?

DIVING Peek a

WE'RE THE DIVING CLUB!

MOUNTA

NEW

Much obliged.

We're Peek-a-Boo!

SHINE

...

ZWOOM

SHINE

SEEMS LIKE A GOOD CLUB FOR GET-TING LAID,

SEEING AS THE DUDE NEXT TO HER'S HAND-SOME, TOO AND-

...

Thanks for helping out.

No biggie.

...BUT THE COAST IS CLEAR, IORI.

PHEW... THANKS.

I'M NOT SURE I FOL-LOW...

SHUFL

WE ARE THE DIVING CLUB, AFTER ALL.

...

IT'S A WETSUIT SUBSTI-TUTE.

YOU'RE THE LAST PERSON I WANT TO HEAR THAT FROM.

WHAT'S WITH THAT GETUP, ANYWAY?

SHEESH... HOW THE HELL DID YOU GET SECURITY CALLED ON YOU?

SHINE

WHY ARE YOU MOVING THE CONVERSA-TION IN A WAY THAT IMPLIES I'M GOING TO BOTH DRINK AND STRIP AGAIN?

SINCE WE'RE DRINKING LATER, AREN'T YOU JUST GON-NA HAVE TO TAKE THEM OFF AGAIN?

THAT'S A WEIRD THING TO ASK.

HOW IS IT WEIRD? LOOK AT ME.

WHAT-EVER.

I HAVE A FAVOR TO ASK, AC-TUALLY.

WHAT'S UP?

TRA & FIELD

CAN YOU LEND ME SOME CLOTHES?

THAT'S A VERY TEMPTING OFFER, BUT I NEED TO FIND SOME CLOTHES.

TODAY'S THE *FRESHMEN WELCOMING PARTY.*

IT'S OUR TREAT, Y'KNOW.

AND I'LL PAY FOR THE DRINKS.

HMM...

...

YOU ALREADY WERE PAYING.

I'LL LEND YOU SOME CLOTHES IF YOU RECRUIT EVEN A SINGLE FRESHMAN.

HOW'S THAT?

I'D LOVE TO LEND YOU SOME, BUT ALL I HAVE IS A T-SHIRT.

WHY DO YOU CARE? YOU STREAKED DOWN THE STREET YESTERDAY.

I GUESS THEY COULD TELL ME WHERE GRAND BLUE IS, TOO, SO IT'S NOT A BAD DEAL...

LET'S DO THIS, THEN.

DONE DEAL.

ANY IDEAS FOR RE-CRUITS?

ALL RIGHT! YOU'RE ON!

カリ

BAP!!

YEAH.

LEAVE IT TO ME.

NEW MEMBERS

MOUNTAIN CLIMBING

DANCE

NEW MEMBERS

GAME DEV

DANCE

HOW COULD THIS BE?!

WHAT

DAMN IT ALL!

WHY?!

WHY ISN'T THERE A CLUB FULL OF BEAUTIFUL HIGH SCHOOL GIRLS TO BE MY HAREM?!

ポン
PAT

!

WHY ?!

WHY ...?

SKF

SKF

YOU ...

DON'T GIVE UP, KOHEI.

YOUR DREAMS WILL COME TRUE AS LONG AS YOU PERSEVERE.

ISN'T THAT HOW THE WORLD WORKS?

BUT ...

... REALITY IS CRUEL.

EVERY PERSON I TALK TO...

...KEEPS SAYS THINGS LIKE, "STOP DREAMING," OR, "WHAT COLLEGE HAS HIGH SCHOOL GIRLS?" OR "JOIN AN ANIME CLUB!"

WHAT THE HELL IS THAT SUPPOSED TO MEAN?!

IT'S OUT THERE.

...I THOUGHT A WHOLE NEW WORLD...

...AND LIFESTYLE OF MY DREAMS WOULD BE WAITING FOR ME!

WHEN I CAME TO COL-LEGE...

...

HUH?

REALLY ...?

YOU JUST HAVEN'T FOUND THE DOOR LEADING TO IT.

OF COURSE IT IS.

A NEW WORLD AND A FANTAS-TIC LIFE-STYLE.

WHY DON'T WE STEP FOOT INTO THE WORLD OF DREAMS TOGETHER?

YEAH.

HOW ABOUT IT?

GWAHAHA

YOU TRICKED ME, YOU BASTARD!

PHEW... CLOTHES ARE ONE OF MANKIND'S GREATEST INVENTIONS.

MEEOOOOOW!

PLEASE LINE UP AND SHOW US THE ARM YOU HAD TAPED EARLIER SO WE CAN SEAT YOU!

WELCOME TO THE DIVING CLUB, PEEK-A-BOO!

ALL RIGHT, FRESHMEN.

*To promote safe drinking, they're using patch tests to measure alcohol tolerance.

JUST HEAD ON OVER TO TABLE A.

OH, IORI. WE ALREADY KNOW ABOUT YOU, SO DON'T WORRY.

HUH? OKAY ...

WHAT ARE YOU DOING?

TABLE B FOR YOU.

OKAY. HEAD TO TABLE C.

...

Table A	Table B	Table C
Whiskey Vodka Alcohol Content 20%~	Beer Sours Alcohol Content 3-8%	Soft Drinks Alcohol Content None

SO, WHAT'LL YOU HAVE, IORI?

OOLONG TEA, PLEASE.

COMING UP.

キュポッ SQUEE POP

I'M NOT GONNA BE THE ONE STRIPPING TODAY!

LET'S HAVE ANOTHER GOOD ROUND OF DRINKING!

HEY! IT'S THE NEWBIE FROM YESTERDAY! OVER HERE!

TRANSFER! TRANSFER ME TO TABLE B!

THERE YOU GO. OOLONG TEA.

BAM

THIS ISN'T ANY OOLONG TEA I'VE HAD BEFORE!

トク GLUG

9 Parts Vodka

トク GLUG

1 Part Whiskey

THE FACT THAT YOU CAN LIGHT IT ON FIRE MEANS IT'S MOSTLY ALCOHOL!

FWOOF

YEAH, AND IT'S NOT JUST THE COLOR. IT EVEN LIGHTS ON FIRE, TOO.

CHIK

WHAT'RE YOU TALKING ABOUT? IT LOOKS JUST LIKE OOLONG TEA.

FWOOF

SHIK

SZZZ...

HERE, IORI. HAVE SOME WATER.

C'MON, GUYS. DON'T BULLY THE NEW GUY TOO MUCH.

OH, THANK YOU.

DO YOU PEOPLE HAVE ANY OTHER WAY OF DIFFER-ENTIATING BETWEEN DRINKS APART FROM COLOR?

IT LOOKS JUST LIKE WATER. DON'T WORRY ABOUT IT.

MUST BE FLAM-MABLE WATER.

...WHY CAN I LIGHT THIS WATER ON FIRE?

CHEERS!

ALL RIGHT, EVERYONE. LET'S HAVE A GOOD TIME!

おっ WOOOOOOOOOO っ

CHEERS!

*A reference to the kanji used in "kanpai," the Japanese word for "cheers."

ONE, TWO ... CHEERS!

ニ"おおぉ RAAAH

...

...AND READ AS "CHEERS!"*

Table A

IT'S WRITTEN AS "DRAIN YOUR GLASS..."

Table C

アハハハハハハハハ AH HA HA HA HA HA

Table B

FU フフフフフ FU FU FU FU

ぎゃはは
GA HA HA HA
SNEAK SNEAK
こそこそ

CHISA!

YOU CAME.

...

HM?

NOOO THANKS.

ビッ
FWIP

RELUC-TANTLY.

YOU?

ONLY BECAUSE MY DAD WOULDN'T SHUT UP ABOUT IT.

...

ARE YOU GOING TO JOIN THE CLUB?

THINK YOU'LL GET AWAY?

HMM.

HUH?

YEAH! C'MON, WE'RE REDO-ING THE TOAST!

わっしょい HEAVE-HO

わっしょい HEAVE-HO

YO, IORI! YOU GOTTA TOAST PROPERLY!

HEY! WAI-

DUM-MY.

ゴクゴクゴクゴクゴクゴクゴクゴク GULP GULP GULP GULP GULP

CHEEERS!

WRITTEN AS "DRAIN YOUR GLASS!"

GULP
GULP
GULP
GULP

DRINK SOME WATER, TOO, OR YOU'LL PASS OUT.

SWIF

GAAAH

MAN, THAT'S SOME STRONG STUFF!

...

OH, THANKS.

VODKAAA!

YOU KNOW HOW TO THROW 'EM BACK, IORI KITAHARA.

CHIK

FWOOSH

NOTHING OF THE SORT.

IT'S JUST ...

K-KOHEI! IS THIS YOUR WAY OF GET-TING RE-VENGE?!

YOU'RE RIGHT. I SUPPOSE SOMEONE HAS TO BE SACRIFICED.

...

...I FIGURE THE ONLY WAY OUT IS TO GET SOMEONE HAMMERED AND HAVE THEM JOIN FIRST.

HAHAHAHA

GHRHHRHR

YEAH. I'M THE ONE WHO BROUGHT YOU HERE.

DO YOU FOLLOW ME?

CHIK

FWOOF

GULP GULP GULP

...

I'LL TAKE RESPONSIBILITY AND DRINK THE BOOZE. WHY DON'T YOU HAVE SOME OOLONG TEA?

YOUR SELF-SACRIFICING MENTALITY IS ADMIRABLE.

WHOA, WHOA. NO FIGHTING, YOU TWO.

IF YOU'RE GONNA GO AT IT, THEN MAKE IT A CONTEST.

うG ガR ぬN かR ああA あA あH おR あG あH

YOU ASS-HOLE!

HAVING SOMEONE TAKE THE FALL IS A GREAT IDEA!

DROWN YOUR LIVER FOR MY SAKE, KOHEI IMAMURA!

CON-TEST?

...STARING CONTEST.

THAT'S RIGHT.

WITH A TRADI-TIONAL P.A.B. STYLE...

WELL, THEN.

ALL RIGHT.

NOD コクリ

IF YOU SPIT OUT THE SAKE IN YOUR MOUTH, YOU HAVE TO DOWN A GLASS.

THE RULES ARE SIM-PLE.

...

I SEE.

YEAH. IN SITUATIONS WHERE YOU'RE NOT SUPPOSED TO LAUGH, PEOPLE TEND TO LAUGH WHEN SOMEONE ACTS SERIOUS.

...

GRG ゲラゲラ

SERI-OUS?

KOHEI, ONE IDEA IS TO TRY HAVING A SERIOUS CONVERSA-TION.

...

GOOD IDEA.

ALL RIGHT. I'LL TALK ABOUT SOMETHING THAT'S BEEN BOTHERING ME.

THE TRUTH IS...

JUST BETWEEN YOU AND ME.

BRGH?!

ブッ PFFF

...I MIGHT NOT LOOK LIKE IT, BUT I USED TO BE A HUGE OTAKU.

S! O! SOSO! SO-SO-U! SO-SO-U!

ERG

THAT'S A SOSOU, IORI.

HEH. SEEMS YOU WEREN'T ABLE TO CONTAIN YOUR SURPRISE.

NO SHIT I'M SURPRISED! YOU ACTUALLY THOUGHT YOU WERE HIDING THE FACT THAT YOU'RE AN OTAKU?!

*What is sosou?

A penalty requiring one to down their drink in the event of a blunder such as spilling food or drink, or acting rude towards one's seniors. Variations of the penalty also occur when one doesn't empty their glass or forgets to say thanks for the meal.

SMIRK
ニヤリ
SLURP
ズルッ
OOF...
ゴクゴクゴクゴクゴクゴク
GULP GULP GULP GULP GULP GULP
WOBL WOBL
フラ フラ
YOUR TURN, IORI.
...IORI?
...!
HEY, ARE YOU OKAY?
HUMP
ドサッ
GOD DAMN IT!

AW YEAH! BOT-TOMS UP, KOHEI!

COUGH COUGH COUGH

ポP A ン T

YOU, TOO, IORI.

...

I WANT ... ...TO PLAY BAS-KET-BALL.*

BRGH?!

PFFF

*A reference to the manga Slam Dunk.

YEEEAH! WOOOO!

ゴク GULP ゴク GULP ゴク GULP ゴクゴクゴク GULP

WOO うおー

OKAY! CHUG! CHUG! CHUG! CHUG! ☆

BURP

YOU'RE NOT SO BAD, YOUR-SELF!

BURP

YOU'RE PRETTY GOOD.

ポイッ TOSS

ポイッ TOSS

JUST DON'T KILL YOUR-SELVES!

THAT'S THE SPIRIT, FRESH-MEN!

BRING IT ON! I'LL SHOW YOU WHO'S ON TOP!

IF IT'S COME TO THIS, I'M GONNA GO ALL OUT!

THドシュッUD

ゴロッ ROLL

♪ LET'S HAVE A STARING CONTEST! PEEK A—

TOLD YOU SO.

SAW THAT COM-ING.

スイ
SWI

W-WA-TER...

うぷっ
HGH

ビチャビチャ
BLL
IIº
IIº
IIº
R
R

IIº
IIº
G
H

GULP GULP GULP GULP
ゴク ゴク ゴク ゴク

I GOTTA SAY, I'M A LITTLE SUR-PRISED.

I SWEAR, YOU GUYS...

HERE.

ピタッ
FREEZE

...

THANKS ...

S-SOR-RY...

FWIP

IF YOU WANTED STRONGER BOOZE, ALL YOU HAD TO DO WAS ASK!

SPIRYTU

Alcohol 96%

I DIDN'T THINK YOU GUYS WERE THIS SHY.

GOGOGOG

I'M GLAD HE'S TAKEN AN INTEREST IN DIVING.

THAT'S GOOD.

YEAH, BUT...

TAK TAK

I GUESS IORI-KUN AND HIS FRIEND ARE GOING TO JOIN THE CLUB.

TAK TAK

Gr

A

THIS IS THE SECOND NIGHT IN A ROW HE HASN'T SLEPT AT HOME.

I NEED TO SCOLD HIM.

THIS IS ALL YOUR FAULT...

THROB ズキ ズキ THROB

NO WAY... IT'S YOURS.

THROB ズキ ズキ THROB

はぁ…
SIGH

GOD...

THAT IDIOT...

CH.2/End


Professor still unfazed.
...
Let's begin the lesson, shall we?
'Kaaay.

Grand Blue Dreaming